Shaping the future of sustainable finance - from market growth to economic transformation

By Clara Raposo

PDF (8 Pages)

TYPE

Speech

SUBTYPE

Central banker's speech

DATE DELIVERED

27 October 2026

Welcome to the new BIS website. Please share your feedback to help us improve.

Keynote address by Ms Clara Raposo, Vice-Governor of the Banco de Portugal, at the CESG (Commission on Environment, Social, and Governance) Conference 2026, Lisbon, 7 October 2026.

It is a great pleasure to join you today and contribute to this discussion on the future of sustainable finance.

The title of this conference asks whether sustainable finance needs reinvention or a reality check. My answer is that it needs both realism and evolution.

The reality check is that sustainable finance has grown considerably, but unevenly, and its expansion has slowed in some markets. More importantly, **the growth of sustainable financial products has not yet translated fully into the scale of productive investment required**.

The evolution must therefore be towards a more mature model—one that moves beyond an excessive focus on labels and commitments and **concentrates instead on financing credible business transformation, strengthening resilience and supporting long-term prosperity**.

We must also **be realistic about the economic context**. Geopolitical fragmentation has increased. Security and resilience have become central economic concerns. Fiscal space is constrained. Energy costs and industrial competitiveness have moved to the forefront. At the same time, economies must finance several transformations: decarbonisation, defence, digitalisation, demographic adaptation, and infrastructure.

Welcome to the new BIS website. Please share your feedback to help us improve.

The views expressed in this speech are those of the speaker and do not necessarily reflect those of the BIS.

PDF (8 Pages)

Authors

Clara Raposo
Deputy Governor

Welcome to the new BIS website. Please share your feedback to help us improve.

SIGN UP TO RECEIVE EMAIL ALERTS

BIS alerts

Welcome to the new BIS website. Please share your feedback to help us improve.